Request for Information (RFI)

High Definition (HD) Rotary-Wing Aircraft Camera Systems

Issued By:
United States Coast Guard (USCG)
Aviation Logistics Center (ALC)
Engineering Services Division

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1.0 GENERAL INFORMATION

1.1 Purpose

The United States Coast Guard (USCG) is issuing this Request for Information (RFI) to conduct market research in accordance with Federal Acquisition Regulation (FAR) Part 10. The goal is to identify sources capable of providing High Definition (HD) Hoist and Cabin Camera Systems for its fleet of over 120 MH-60 and MH-65 rotary-wing aircraft.

This RFI seeks to gather information on available commercial-off-the-shelf (COTS) or non-developmental items and industry capabilities to inform a potential future acquisition.

1.2 Background

The effective execution of numerous USCG missions is critically dependent on the ability to capture high-quality imagery from hoist and cabin-mounted cameras. The current camera systems are standard definition. The USCG is seeking to identify and understand available HD technologies that could serve as a maintainable, form-fit-function replacement for the existing system, improving situational awareness and mission effectiveness without requiring significant airframe modification.

1.3 Scope

The scope of this RFI includes all hardware, software, and potential support services necessary for a complete HD camera system solution. This includes the camera units, data interfaces, and any associated components required for operation in a demanding military aviation environment.

2.0 SYSTEM REQUIREMENTS

Vendors are requested to describe how their solution(s) meet the following technical characteristics. Please address each point and note the Technology Readiness Level (TRL) of the proposed system(s).

2.1 Operational Capabilities

The camera system must be capable of:

- Integration using existing aircraft mounting hardware and electrical interfaces.
- Clearly capturing video of hoisting operations at ranges between 40 and 200 feet below the helicopter.
- Providing constant, real-time video streaming to an aircraft recording device via an RG-179 data interface.

2.2 Physical and Environmental Characteristics

Characteristic	Requirement
Dimensions	Camera(s): Not to exceed 2.25” x 2.25” footprint.
Weight	Not to exceed 2.0 lbs. per camera unit.
Durability	Must withstand shock and vibration IAW RTCA DO-160.
Ingress Protection	Must be sealed to be 100% waterproof to protect internal electronics and optics from moisture and environmental contaminants IAW RTCA DO-160.
Corrosion Resistance	All external materials must be manufactured to withstand a saltwater-rich, corrosive operational environment.
Operating Temperature	-40°C to +70°C.
Altitude	The lens system must be fog-proof and capable of handling rapid altitude changes from sea level to 10,000 feet Above Ground Level (AGL).

2.3 Electrical and Performance Characteristics

Characteristic	Requirement
Power	28VDC (2-wire, positive and neutral).
Data Interface	RG-179 Coaxial Cable.
Video Signal	Capable of outputting HD signal types (e.g., 720p, 1080p, 4K). Please specify supported formats.
Sensor/Resolution	1/3-inch color CCD or CMOS sensor (or equivalent) with a native resolution sufficient to produce a minimum of 720 horizontal television lines.
Low-Light Sensitivity	Minimum illumination of 0.1 Lux at F2.0 (Color) and 0.05 Lux at F2.0 (Monochrome), or better.
Lens (Hoist Camera)	Approximately 3.6mm lens providing a field of view of approximately 54° (H) x 70° (V).
Lens (Cabin Camera)	Approximately 3.05mm lens providing a field of view of approximately 74° (H) x 90° (V).
Optical Glass Quality	Surface quality of 60-40 scratch-dig, or better.
Unit Identification	Camera units must be clearly and permanently marked with a manufacturer part number and a unique serial number.

2.4 Compliance and Qualifications

Please describe the compliance status of your proposed system(s) with the following standards. Indicate if the system is fully certified, designed to meet, compliant by similarity, or if testing is planned.

- MIL-STD-704F (Aircraft Electric Power Characteristics)

- MIL-STD-461E/G (EMI/EMC)
- MIL-STD-810H (Environmental Engineering Considerations)
- RTCA/DO-160E/G (Environmental Conditions and Test Procedures for Airborne Equipment)
- Connectors compliant with MIL-DTL-26482H.

3.0 REQUESTED INFORMATION

3.1 Company Information
Please provide the following:

- Company Name, Address, and Website.
- Point of Contact (Name, Title, Email, Phone).
- CAGE Code and Unique Entity ID (UEI).
- Business Size and any applicable socio-economic classifications.

3.2 Technical and Product Information

- Please provide a detailed narrative addressing how your proposed solution meets each requirement listed in Section 2.0.
- Include complete product data sheets, specifications, and mounting requirement layouts for all proposed camera solutions.
- Is your solution currently in production (TRL 9)? If not, what is its current Technology Readiness Level (TRL) and planned production date?
- Provide details on a one year standard warranty, support, and repair terms included with the product.

3.3 Past Performance & Experience

- Describe your organization's specific experience in developing, manufacturing, and supporting ruggedized camera systems for military, aviation, or similarly harsh environments.
- Do you have other U.S. Government or military agencies using this product? If so, please identify the agencies if the information is public.

3.4 Acquisition and Contracting Information

- Does your company have existing Government-Wide Acquisition Contracts (GWAC) (e.g., GSA Schedule, SEWP) or other strategically sourced contracts where these products could be procured? If yes, please provide the contract number(s).
- What information or resources (e.g., Government Furnished Information or Equipment) would you typically need from the USCG to perform this effort?
- If significant subcontracting or teaming is anticipated, please describe the management structure of such arrangements.

3.5 Rough Order of Magnitude (ROM) Pricing

Please provide a ROM price for budgetary and planning purposes only. This does not constitute a formal proposal, and pricing will not be used for source selection. To the greatest extent possible, please detail the following:

- Estimated price per unit for both the hoist and cabin camera.
- A description of any potential Non-Recurring Engineering (NRE) costs that may be associated with system configuration or qualification.
- An overview of estimated lifecycle and supportability costs (e.g., training, standard warranty, extended warranty options, and mean time between failure).

3.6 Production & Delivery Capability

Please describe your company's production capacity and standard delivery timelines. This information should reflect your firm's general capabilities.

- Estimated lead time (in days) from order placement to initial delivery.

4.0 RESPONSE INSTRUCTIONS AND DISCLAIMER

4.1 Response Submission

Interested parties are requested to submit a response of no more than 10 pages, not including product data sheets. Responses should be submitted in PDF format via email to Jackson.S.Perry@uscg.mil (Jackson Perry) no later than the response due date listed above. Please refer to the RFI number in the subject line.

4.2 Disclaimer and Terms of Use

- This RFI is issued solely for information and planning purposes and does not constitute a solicitation (Request for Proposal, Request for Quotation) or a promise to issue a solicitation in the future.

- This RFI does not commit the U.S. Government to contract for any supply or service. Respondents are advised that the U.S. Government will not pay for any information or administrative costs incurred in response to this RFI; all costs shall be borne by the respondent.
- Do not include proprietary, classified, confidential, or sensitive information in your response. The Government reserves the right to use any non-proprietary information provided by respondents for any purpose determined necessary and legally appropriate, including using technical information to develop a resultant solicitation.
- It is the responsibility of interested parties to monitor the System for Award Management (SAM.gov) website for any potential future solicitation announcements. Failure to respond to this RFI will not prevent a firm from submitting a proposal to any future solicitation, if one is issued.